

FIELD + PHONE SALES

CITYBEAT SALES PLAYBOOK

Product knowledge. Safe checkout. Confident closes.

SELL THE RIGHT FIT Match the customer's goal to a directory plan, ad placement, job post, or featured event.	CLOSE SECURELY Use CityBeat's Stripe Checkout link. The customer always enters their own card details.	FOLLOW THROUGH Confirm payment, ownership handoff, fulfillment, and your commission record.
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Built for CityBeat sales representatives working in person, by phone, and through warm-lead follow-up. Keep this guide internal and use the live Sales Desk as the final pricing authority.

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01 | FAST START

The four moves behind every clean sale

A sale is not complete when a link is sent. It is complete when Stripe confirms payment and the correct product can be fulfilled.

1. DISCOVER What outcome does the business need now?	2. RECOMMEND One primary product and one clear reason.	3. CHECK OUT Generate the secure CityBeat Stripe link.	4. CONFIRM Verify successful payment and next steps.
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NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

- **Use the live wizard as final authority.** Prices and availability can change after this guide is printed.
- **Never handle card details.** The customer types their card into Stripe Checkout on their own device.
- **Confirm the exact product, term, and total before generating a link.**
- **Only send CityBeat-generated Stripe links.** Valid links begin with checkout.stripe.com or buy.stripe.com.
- **Do not promise guaranteed leads, sales, traffic, placement dates, or editorial coverage.**
- **Do not invent discounts.** Use Founding 100, annual savings, or a manager-approved custom amount only.

	OPEN THE SALES DESK https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/me#new-sale Scan or click to work leads, create any product checkout, and track the customer brief in one place. Login and an approved sales role are required.
ORDERS + PIPELINE https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/me	MY BANK AND PAYOUTS https://citybeatmag.co/en/account/payments

02 | PRODUCT KNOWLEDGE

Directory plans and the Founding 100 offer

Directory subscriptions are priced per location. Start with the customer's need: accurate presence, immediate leads, richer content, or maximum category visibility.

PLAN	PRICE	BEST FOR	CUSTOMER VALUE / SALES ANGLE
Basic	\$0	A no-risk first step	Listed in the directory, eligible for reviews, and able to see that leads exist. Lead contact details remain masked.
Founding Monthly	\$9.99/mo	Price-sensitive early adopters	All Premium features at the Founding 100 launch rate, locked for the life of the active subscription. Limited to the first 100 paid claimers.
Founding Annual	\$99/yr \$8.25/mo effective	Owners ready to commit	Lowest published Premium price. Saves \$140 versus twelve Premium Monthly payments and stays locked for the life of the active subscription.
Premium Monthly	\$19.99/mo	Flexible month-to-month buyers	Full leads, photo gallery, cover image, custom description, social links, business hours, deals, and priority directory placement.
Premium Annual	\$199/yr \$16.58/mo effective	Stable businesses seeking savings	All Premium benefits with two months free versus monthly billing.
Featured	\$49/mo	Businesses fighting for category leadership	Everything in Premium plus top-of-category placement, a Featured badge, and homepage rotation.

Founding 100 must be confirmed live

Never promise Founding availability until checkout accepts it. The offer is capped at 100 paid claimers and the server blocks new Founding sales when the cap is reached. If a customer cancels, do not promise they can return at the same price. Monthly and Annual Founding options are both in the Sales Desk.

THE PREMIUM VALUE STACK

NEED	LIVE BENEFIT	HOW TO SAY IT
More customer inquiries	Full lead contact details instead of masked leads	You can respond while the customer is still deciding.
A stronger storefront	Photos, cover image, description, hours, and social links	Give local customers enough confidence to call, visit, or request a quote.
More visibility	Priority placement; Featured adds top-category and homepage rotation	Stand above basic listings when readers are actively browsing your category.
Retention and proof	Monthly views, leads, and review reporting	Use real activity to judge value rather than relying on guesswork.

AI assistant and AI-concierge benefits appear in product documentation, but AI services may be dormant until platform keys are enabled. Do not sell them as guaranteed live features without management confirmation.

03 | PRODUCT KNOWLEDGE

Advertising, recruitment, and event products

Every published product is available in the Sales Desk. The customer pays first, then completes a product-specific brief; CityBeat creates a staff-review record only after required information is complete.

PRODUCT	RATE	WHAT THE CUSTOMER GETS	BEST SALES ANGLE
Newsletter Sponsorship	\$50 monthly	Top placement in the weekly send, bilingual creative review, and a campaign performance summary.	Reach readers in a focused, repeat habit: the newsletter they already open.
Sponsored Story	\$30 per post	Native story placement, editorial production guidance, and category plus social distribution.	Explain a business, launch, founder story, or community impact with more depth than an ad.
Category Banner	\$25 monthly	Category-page placement, leaderboard and rectangle formats, and simple monthly reporting.	Put a timely offer beside readers already browsing a relevant topic.
Featured Event	\$25 one time	A complete paid event brief with Featured placement after staff review.	Give a time-sensitive event stronger visibility while collecting dates, venue, tickets, accessibility, and artwork once.
Job Posting	\$50 one time	A complete local job brief prepared for a 30-day posting after staff review.	Recruit locally with clear category, workplace type, pay, benefits, qualifications, and application details.
Custom Ad / Package	Approved quote	A one-time custom charge for a banner, sponsored placement, or negotiated package. The receipt carries the description you enter.	Fit the campaign to the customer's goal, timing, and budget while keeping every deliverable explicit.

Approved audience statements

The advertising page currently states 50,000+ monthly bilingual readers, 5 core coverage zones, and a 24-hour campaign review target. Present these as CityBeat's current published claims, not as guaranteed impressions, sales, or approval times.

SMART COMBINATIONS - WITHOUT INVENTING A DISCOUNT

CUSTOMER GOAL	RECOMMENDED COMBINATION	WHY IT WORKS
Launch a new location	Premium Annual + Sponsored Story	Build an always-on business profile, then tell the launch story.
Promote a seasonal offer	Premium Monthly + Category Banner	Strengthen the listing and add a timely category-level call to action.
Drive event awareness	Featured Event + Sponsored Story	Add immediate placement plus context that explains why the event matters.
Hire locally	Job Posting + Newsletter Sponsorship	Keep the job live for 30 days and add concentrated newsletter reach.

Quote each published line item or use one manager-approved custom amount with a detailed receipt description. A combination is not automatically a discount.

04 | CONSULTATIVE SELLING

Diagnose first, recommend second

The strongest close is a short recommendation tied directly to what the owner said they need. Do not present every product at once.

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS	LISTEN FOR
1. How do new customers find you today? 2. Which service, product, event, or opening matters most this month? 3. Do you need ongoing visibility or a one-time push? 4. Are customers calling, visiting, requesting quotes, buying tickets, or applying? 5. What area or category should see the offer? 6. Do you have photos, a story, or an offer ready? 7. What would make this worthwhile in the next 30 to 90 days?	- Weak or incomplete online presence - Missed or slow lead follow-up - A launch, sale, hiring need, or event deadline - Desire for bilingual local reach - Need for a measurable report - Need for category leadership - Budget preference: monthly, annual, or one-time

THE ONE-LINE RECOMMENDATION

Use this formula

Because you said **[goal/problem]**, I recommend **[one product]** because it gives you **[specific benefit]**. The investment is **[exact price and term]**. Would you like to activate it now?

IF THE CUSTOMER SAYS...	LEAD WITH...	WHY
I just need to be found accurately	Basic or Premium	Basic removes risk; Premium turns the profile into a richer storefront.
I need customer inquiries now	Premium	Full lead details and a stronger profile support faster response.
I want the top position	Featured	Top-of-category, badge, and homepage rotation are the clearest visibility upgrade.
I have an announcement or story	Sponsored Story	More room for context, trust, and distribution than a banner.
I have a short-term offer	Category Banner	Contextual placement supports a focused call to action.
I need repeat exposure	Newsletter Sponsorship	Weekly placement supports repetition and recall.
I need applicants	Job Posting	A simple 30-day local recruitment product.
My event is soon	Featured Event	A paid, complete brief moves into the staff review queue with enhanced placement requested.

Pricing discipline

Say the full term every time: '\$19.99 per month,' '\$199 per year,' or '\$50 for 30 days.' Never present recurring pricing as if it were a one-time charge.

05 | SALES ANGLES

Turn features into customer outcomes

Use one angle that fits the conversation. Keep claims specific, believable, and connected to a live product benefit.

PRODUCT	ANGLE	HIGHLIGHT	CLOSE QUESTION
Basic	No-risk ownership	Claim the presence customers may already find, correct details, and start building reviews.	Would it help to secure the profile first, then decide on promotion?
Founding	Urgency plus protected value	Premium capability at the lowest launch pricing while limited inventory remains.	If checkout confirms a Founding spot, would you prefer monthly or the annual value?
Premium	A better digital storefront	Full leads, richer information, deals, and stronger directory placement support conversion.	Would faster access to customer inquiries be worth activating today?
Featured	Category leadership	The strongest directory visibility package for a competitive category.	Is being seen before basic and Premium listings the priority?
Newsletter	Concentrated repeat attention	A weekly habit, premium placement, bilingual creative review, and reporting.	Which four-week period matters most for your campaign?
Sponsored Story	Trust through explanation	Tell the founder, launch, expertise, or community story in a useful format.	What would you want a local reader to understand after reading it?
Category Banner	Contextual demand	Put a focused offer beside people already browsing the relevant subject.	Which category and offer should the banner own this month?
Featured Event	Time-sensitive visibility	A complete event brief and Featured placement request support a short runway without publishing incomplete details.	How many days do you have before the event?
Job Posting	Simple local recruiting	One price for a 30-day listing aimed at the regional community.	When do you need applications to start arriving?

Use proof without overpromising

Show the live directory preview, product page, placement examples, or available campaign reporting. Say 'designed to improve visibility' rather than 'guaranteed to bring customers.'

A GOOD RECOMMENDATION IS NARROW

- Recommend one main product first. Offer an add-on only when it serves the same stated goal.
- Use the customer's own words when describing the problem and expected outcome.
- Anchor annual plans to their effective monthly value, then state the full annual charge clearly.
- When a customer is not ready to buy, claim Basic free and schedule the next conversation.

06 | IN-PERSON PROCEDURE

Charge on the spot with a Stripe QR code

The Sales Desk creates a Stripe-hosted checkout link and an on-device QR for every product. The customer pays privately, then continues through the same order into a product-specific fulfillment brief.

Before you begin

Confirm your sales access, connect your bank under My Bank and Payouts, and collect the business name, customer email, optional phone, exact product, exact term, and permission to send the link.

STEP BY STEP

- 1. Open the Sales Desk.** Sign in and go to <https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/me#new-sale>. Leads, checkout creation, and order status are on the same screen.
- 2. Choose the exact product.** Use the grouped selector for any Directory plan, Newsletter Sponsorship, Sponsored Story, Category Banner, Featured Event, 30-Day Job Posting, or manager-approved custom quote.
- 3. Enter the essentials once.** Add the exact business name and a valid customer email. The email prefills Stripe and the post-payment brief. Add a phone only with permission.
- 4. Confirm price and cadence.** Fixed prices come from the server. Directory, Newsletter Sponsorship, and Category Banner recur automatically. For custom, enter the approved USD amount and exact deliverable.
- 5. Read back the offer.** Say the product, deliverable, amount, and billing term. Correct any error before continuing.
- 6. Create checkout.** Select the single checkout button. A Stripe URL, local QR, email, text, open, and copy actions appear in the same panel.
- 7. Let the customer pay.** Have the customer scan the QR code. They review Stripe Checkout and enter their own card details.
- 8. Continue into the customer brief.** After Stripe confirms payment, the customer lands on the correct private wizard. Known details are prefilled, progress autosaves, and a private resume link is emailed.
- 9. Complete required details.** Help the customer understand what CityBeat needs, but let them enter job, event, listing, campaign, copy, and image details. Do not upload private card or identity documents.
- 10. Confirm the handoff.** The Sales Desk should show Paid, Brief Submitted, and Fulfillment In Review. Start another sale only after the first customer's outcome is clear.

Card safety

Never type, photograph, write down, repeat, or store a customer's card number, security code, banking login, or Stripe password. If the customer cannot complete checkout privately, send the link for later instead of taking the card yourself.

IF THIS HAPPENS	DO THIS
Wrong price or description	Stop. Start a new sale and generate a fresh link. Do not ask the customer to pay an incorrect checkout.
Customer cancels Stripe	Clarify the concern, correct the offer if needed, and generate a new link only when they are ready.
Payment fails	Let Stripe display the error. The customer may retry or use another card; you do not troubleshoot their card details.
QR will not scan	Use Open checkout on a separate device or Copy link and send it to the customer.

07 | PHONE PROCEDURE

Close remotely with email, SMS, link, or QR

For a customer using the same phone, a clickable link is better than a QR code. Keep the customer on the call while they open and review Stripe Checkout.

1. **Verify the decision maker.** Confirm the business, contact name, callback number, and email. Never ask for card details.
2. **Agree on the offer.** Read the product, deliverables, exact charge, and recurring or one-time term.
3. **Build the checkout.** Use the unified Sales Desk for every product. The selected product controls recurring versus one-time billing and which customer brief opens after payment.
4. **Choose the best handoff.** Use **Email the link** for a clear branded message. Use **Text the link** only with permission and only when SMS is configured. Otherwise use **Copy link** and send it through the approved business channel.
5. **Have the customer verify it.** Ask them to confirm the Stripe page shows the expected business, product, price, and term before paying.
6. **Stay available, not intrusive.** Remain on the line for questions, but be silent while they enter card information.
7. **Confirm payment.** Look for success and ask the customer to confirm the Stripe receipt. A sent link is not a paid sale.
8. **Move into the customer brief.** After payment, ask the customer to continue in the private wizard. It prefills known details, autosaves each answer, supports image uploads, and emails a 30-day resume link.

SMS fallback

The current app can email payment links. Texting works only when Twilio is configured. If the wizard reports that texting is unavailable, copy the Stripe link and send it through an approved business messaging channel. Do not use a personal channel if company policy forbids it.

REMOTE QR CODE USE



Use QR only when it helps.

A customer cannot easily scan a QR displayed on the same phone they are using. Prefer the clickable payment link. If the customer has a second device, they can scan the live QR. If policy permits, you may send a screenshot of the generated payment QR through the approved channel - but never edit, crop away the price context, or reuse an old customer's QR.

PHONE CLOSE TALK TRACK

Suggested language

I just sent a secure CityBeat payment link. Please check that the Stripe page shows [product] at [price and term]. I will stay on the line for questions, but you will enter the card privately. Once Stripe confirms payment, I will explain the activation steps.

08 | CONVERSATION TOOLS

Simple scripts that keep the customer in control

Use these as frameworks, not speeches. Personalize the problem, product, and proof while keeping pricing and security exact.

MOMENT	SUGGESTED LANGUAGE
Opening	CityBeat helps local customers discover businesses, events, jobs, and offers across the borderland. May I ask how people find and contact you today?
Problem summary	It sounds like the main gap is [visibility / leads / launch awareness / hiring / event reach].
Recommendation	Because you need [goal], I recommend [product]. It gives you [specific benefit] for [exact price and term].
Proof	Let me show you the live placement, profile preview, product page, or reporting that comes with it.
Close	Would you like to activate it now? I can generate a secure Stripe link while we are together.
No-pressure next step	If today is not the day, I can send the exact offer and we can schedule a short follow-up.

OBJECTION HANDLING

OBJECTION	RESPONSE
I already use Google or Facebook.	That is useful. CityBeat adds a bilingual local context, a controllable business profile, directory discovery, reviews, deals, and local editorial or advertising placements. It complements those channels.
It costs too much.	Which outcome matters enough to pay for: faster lead access, stronger visibility, or a one-time campaign? We can compare monthly, annual, Founding if available, or a smaller one-time product without inventing a discount.
Can you guarantee customers?	No responsible placement can guarantee sales. CityBeat sells visibility, lead access, placement, content, and reporting so you can evaluate performance.
I need to think about it.	Absolutely. Which part needs clarity - fit, timing, price, or deliverables? I can send the exact secure link and follow up at an agreed time.
I do not want a subscription.	A Sponsored Story, Featured Event, Job Posting, or approved custom campaign can be a one-time purchase. I will label the deliverable clearly on the receipt.
Is the payment secure?	Yes. You pay on Stripe's hosted checkout. I never see or collect your card number, and Stripe emails the receipt.
Give me the Founding rate.	I can select Founding Monthly or Founding Annual in the Sales Desk and let checkout confirm availability. I cannot promise either after the 100 spots are filled.

Never argue. Clarify the concern, answer once, and let the customer decide. Pressure creates refunds and damages trust.

09 | PROMOTIONS AND FOLLOW-UP

Create urgency without creating mistrust

Urgency must come from a real limit, a real deadline, or the customer's own timing - never from a made-up expiration or discount.

OFFER	WHAT IS TRUE	HOW TO PRESENT IT	DO NOT SAY
Founding 100 Monthly	\$9.99/month; Premium features; first 100 paid claimers; rate locked for life of active subscription.	If a spot is available, this is the lowest monthly entry into Premium and the rate stays protected while the subscription remains active.	There will always be a spot; you can cancel and return at the same rate; lifetime means forever regardless of subscription status.
Founding 100 Annual	\$99/year; \$8.25/month effective; saves \$140 versus twelve Premium Monthly payments; available in the Sales Desk subject to the same 100-member cap.	Best published value for an owner ready to commit for a year, subject to live availability.	It is refundable; availability is guaranteed; cancellation preserves the Founding rate.
Premium Annual	\$199/year; \$16.58/month effective; two months free versus monthly.	A straightforward savings choice for a stable business that wants Premium for a full year.	It is monthly billing; it includes an extra discount beyond the published annual price.
Custom approved quote	A manager-approved one-time amount with exact deliverables written on the Stripe receipt.	Use when the published products need a clear, negotiated package.	Custom automatically means discounted; verbal extras are included.

FOLLOW-UP CADENCE

WHEN	ACTION	GOAL
Immediately	Send the exact payment link and a one-sentence recap of product, price, and term.	Remove friction and prevent confusion.
10 to 20 minutes	If they expected to pay on the call but did not, ask whether the link opened correctly. Do not ask for card details.	Solve link or product confusion.
Next business day	Follow up with the stated customer goal and one clear call to action.	Reconnect value to their own need.
Day 3	Offer a short answer, preview, or alternate fit - not an unapproved discount.	Address the real blocker.
Day 7	Ask whether to close the file or schedule a future date.	Respect the customer's decision and protect your time.

Work warm leads first

The sales dashboard ranks businesses that opened or clicked outreach. A click is the strongest buying signal; call clickers before open-only prospects. Some email opens can be automated security scans.

10 | AFTER THE CHECKOUT

Fulfillment, commissions, and customer trust

A clean handoff reduces refunds. Set the next expectation before leaving the customer or ending the call.

PRODUCT	WHAT HAPPENS AFTER PAYMENT	REP HANDOFF
Directory subscription	The private wizard collects category, description, address, hours, contact details, logo, cover, gallery, and social links.	Confirm the brief reaches In Review; an admin verifies ownership and publishes the enriched listing.
Advertising	Newsletter, banner, and sponsored-story wizards collect objectives, dates, links, copy, calls to action, logos, artwork, sources, and approvals.	Check creative completeness and the requested placement; staff reviews before activation or publication.
Featured Event	The event wizard collects dates, timezone, format, venue, tickets, price, accessibility, organizer, description, and artwork.	Confirm the paid complete event is in the staff review queue; do not promise publication before review.
Job Posting	The job wizard collects category, employment/workplace type, location, pay range, benefits, description, qualifications, and application details.	Confirm the paid complete job is in review for its 30-day posting; incomplete jobs are never published.
Custom quote	The brief captures the approved deliverable, goal, timing, copy, destination, assets, and approval contact.	Compare the brief to the manager-approved receipt description before fulfillment begins.

Customer wizard standard

Payment unlocks the order brief; it does not replace the brief. The customer needs no account, sees only fields for the purchased product, receives an emailed resume link, and can upload validated images directly. Fulfillment starts only after required fields are submitted.

10A | PROTECT THE RELATIONSHIP

Commission, customer data, and consent

Accurate attribution and careful handling protect the customer, the salesperson, and CityBeat.

YOUR COMMISSION

Current rep split in the application

The current code assigns a sales rep 40% of an attributed directory sale and 50% of an attributed ad or add-on sale. Management controls payout policy and whether recurring subscriptions pay once or residually. Confirm the current compensation policy in your dashboard; never discuss internal splits with customers.

- Connect your bank at <https://citybeatmag.co/en/account/payments>. Stripe transfers require a connected account with payouts enabled.
- Commission records appear after successful processing. A generated or sent link does not earn commission.
- Refunds, failed renewals, or cancellations can change payment and listing status. Do not promise payout timing before it appears in the system.
- Every product sold through the signed-in Sales Desk carries the rep and order attribution into Stripe, fulfillment, and reporting. Never use another rep's login or reuse another customer's link.

CUSTOMER DATA AND CONSENT

DO	DO NOT
Ask permission before emailing or texting; use the business contact data needed for the sale; keep notes factual; use approved CityBeat systems.	Collect card data; send arbitrary links; expose one customer's link to another; promise refunds; upload customer documents to personal storage; claim guaranteed results.

When in doubt

Pause the sale. Confirm the product, price, availability, fulfillment, or policy with management. Then generate a fresh link. It is better to delay checkout than to process the wrong offer.

11 | DESK REFERENCE

The one-page close checklist

Keep this page beside you during calls. The live wizard and Stripe confirmation remain the final authority.

BEFORE ☐ Correct customer and business ☐ Decision maker confirmed ☐ Goal and best-fit product ☐ Exact price and term ☐ Email and consent to send ☐ Fulfillment expectation	BUILD ☐ Exact product selected ☐ Correct price and cadence ☐ Client email prefilled ☐ Offer read back aloud ☐ Fresh Stripe link generated ☐ Valid Stripe host	CLOSE ☐ Customer enters own card ☐ Success or receipt confirmed ☐ Product brief opened ☐ Required details submitted ☐ In Review status checked ☐ Follow-up scheduled
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ALL PRODUCTS IN THE SALES DESK

RECURRING / CARD SAVED IN STRIPE	ONE-TIME / NO RENEWAL
Founding Annual - \$99/yr Founding Monthly - \$9.99/mo Premium Annual - \$199/yr Premium Monthly - \$19.99/mo Featured - \$49/mo Newsletter Sponsorship - \$50/mo Category Banner - \$25/mo	Sponsored Story - \$30 Featured Event - \$25 30-Day Job Posting - \$50 Manager-approved custom quote - approved amount

DIRECT LINKS

RESOURCE	LINK
Sales Desk / new sale	https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/me#new-sale
Orders, pipeline, commission	https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/me
My bank and payouts	https://citybeatmag.co/en/account/payments
Advertising products	https://citybeatmag.co/en/ads
Directory	https://citybeatmag.co/en/directory
Public event calendar	https://citybeatmag.co/en/events
Public jobs board	https://citybeatmag.co/en/jobs

Final close standard

Recommend the right product. State the exact price and term. Let the customer pay privately through Stripe. Confirm success. Complete the product brief. Verify In Review. Record the handoff.

CityBeat internal sales enablement | Questions or pricing exceptions: contact platform management before checkout.